

Contact

akhil_neelam@yahoo.co.in

www.linkedin.com/in/akhilneelam
(LinkedIn)

www.cgapsouthasia.org/
(Company)

www.womenforpolitics.com
(Company)

Top Skills

Policy Design & Implementation

Government Relations &
Stakeholder Engagement

Regulatory & Compliance Strategy

Languages

Telugu (Native or Bilingual)

Tamil (Elementary)

Hindi (Full Professional)

English (Professional Working)

Certifications

Management Consulting
Specialization

altMBA (awarded Leaders of the
World Scholarship)

Honors-Awards

MHRD-CSS Scholarship

Full Scholarship - Young India
Fellowship

GRÓ GEST Fellowship

Youth Co:Lab Springboard Elevate
Fellowship

Publications

South Asia's women leaders:
Disaster management, gender
equality and COVID-19

Safeguarding digital spaces in
Indian/South Asian politics

Women Voters in India Play a
Significant Role in its Electoral

Akhil Neelam

UC Berkeley MBA I Founder I Championing Tech Solutions for
Impact

San Francisco Bay Area

Summary

I'm a full-time MBA student at UC Berkeley Haas School of Business. Prior to business school, I co-founded South Asia's only volunteer-led think tank on gender & politics, growing 140+ members across 14 countries and building a global network of change-makers.

My journey, from building AI partnerships in government to leading product customisation to building an impact startup has been about scaling impact through technology.

Today I'm pivoting into product management / product marketing roles in tech where I can translate user insights into strategy, define data-driven roadmaps, and build human-centered products with measurable impact, whether that's growth, engagement or scalability.

Skills I bring include: user research & personas; cross-functional team leadership; go-to-market planning; data analysis & experimentation; AI/ML strategy in applied contexts.

I'm excited to bring my blend of startup grit, strategic thinking and global leadership into a tech product role that values both business growth and meaningful impact.

Interested in connecting with founders, product leaders and changemakers in tech. Drop me a message or send a connection invite.

Experience

Uniblox

Pre MBA Product Intern

April 2025 - June 2025 (3 months)

Seattle, Washington, United States

System, But They Should Be On the Ballot Too

Harini Amarasuriya: An Academician Rises to Sri Lanka's Premiership

Gender Analysis of Nepal's Local Elections May 2022

- Collaborated with engineering and data science teams to scope and refine features of the group underwriting platform, translating complex technical concepts into actionable product requirements.
- Ran daily stand-ups, tracked progress, and maintained follow-through to ensure feature updates were delivered continuously.
- Analyzed case-data, identified insights, and supported prioritization of product backlog items — enabling user-centric and data-informed decisions.
- Supported go-to-market activities by coordinating with the team on booth appearances and conference preparation, boosting Uniblox's presence across key events.
- Demonstrated strong ownership, clear communication and cross-functional collaboration throughout the product lifecycle.

Assuretrac

Strategy & Operations Consultant

April 2024 - March 2025 (1 year)

Conducted operational analysis to redesign core processes and develop SOPs, driving 30% efficiency improvement and enabling market expansion into two new sectors

Centre for Gender And Politics (CGAP)

Co-founder and Director

July 2021 - March 2025 (3 years 9 months)

Cofounded a think-tank on gender and politics in South Asia!

- Co-founded CGAP as the first-ever think tank exclusively focused on gender inclusion in South Asian politics, designing the operational model, assessing and navigating geopolitical risks, regulatory shifts, and policy trends
- Mobilized and coordinated 140+ high-performance volunteers and cultivated partnerships with 16+ organizations, aligning diverse stakeholders to scale the organizational reach to 8 South Asian countries
- Defined product vision and executed partnership with J.P. Morgan to build a first-of-its-kind online repository for aspiring women politicians in South Asia, creating a scalable CMS platform to democratize access for 10K+ users
- Developed playbooks and OKRs for globally distributed teams, standardizing execution and enabling delivery of research and awareness projects, influencing 5+ UN consultations on women's leadership

- Strategized and executed messaging and positioning that expanded CGAP's visibility across South Asia and EU, including speaking at 15+ global forums (UN Women, G20) that resulted in securing partnerships with 16+ orgs
- Built thought-leadership presence on LinkedIn (1K → 15K followers) to scale organization's visibility, leveraging content strategy to engage global experts and recruit 140+ volunteers across 14 countries

Teach For Change

Advisory Board Member

April 2022 - June 2023 (1 year 3 months)

Hyderabad, Telangana, India

Advised the leadership on strategy, programme development and implementation. With a track record of success spanning over 8 years, Teach for Change has impacted the lives of more than 42,000 children from government schools in Telangana, Andhra Pradesh, and Karnataka states in India.

Central Square Foundation

1 year 8 months

Project Manager

November 2020 - June 2021 (8 months)

Hyderabad, Telangana, India

Gates funded philanthropy, deputed to consult with School Education departments in two Indian states

- Translated insights from 6,600 parent interviews across 33 school districts on access to radio, TV, and internet into tailored learning-continuity programs, mitigating pandemic-driven learning loss for 6M students
- Spearheaded product customization (multi-language, low-data, adaptive pacing) of a WhatsApp learning bot during COVID, keeping 3M students engaged in remote learning and preventing large-scale learning loss
- Executed large user research across 33 school districts (6,600 parent interviews), generating insights on radio, TV and internet access that shaped targeted strategies for mitigating pandemic learning loss affecting 6M students

Project Management Consultant

November 2019 - October 2020 (1 year)

Government of Andhra Pradesh

3 years

Consultant, Project Management Unit (PMU), Department of School Education

September 2018 - June 2020 (1 year 10 months)

Vijayawada Area, India

- Orchestrated a pilot project with 3 tech vendors, 2 consulting firms, and 3 govt depts; developed performance metrics and policy framework that enabled scaling of an AI-based personalized learning solution to 500 schools
- Led partnership with Microsoft to design a predictive ML model using multi-source education data to identify potential school dropouts and rolled out a teacher intervention app, retaining 60,000+ at-risk students
- Secured a partnership and created inter-departmental coordination with the Royal Education Council, Bhutan, to implement a happiness curriculum in 64,000 public schools through cross-country meetings and field visits.

Public Relations Officer

September 2017 - August 2018 (1 year)

New Delhi

- Mobilized 20+ national and international media houses to cover 3 big summits in the state, including the Andhra Pradesh AgTech Summit which hosted Bill Gates
- Media Relations: Liaised with and strategised the engagement with national and international media for promoting policy and political initiatives
- Communications: Drafted press releases and multimedia content
- Inter-departmental Collaboration: Consulted departments and government officials to identify and document good governance initiatives in the form of creative media stories and briefings

Summer Fellow, Department of School Education

July 2017 - September 2017 (3 months)

Vijayawada

- To investigate and document high performing initiatives, best practices and hidden stories of good governance in the School Education Department, Andhra Pradesh.

- Documentation of the initiatives in the form of a Compendium that can be officially released by the Commissionerate of School Education (CSE).

Parliament of India

Policy Research Intern (Office of Member of Parliament, Jodhpur)

May 2017 - June 2017 (2 months)

New Delhi Area, India

Co-authored a chapter on the social theme of 'Gender Inequality' by providing solution specific research insights. Researched on how the current schemes can be interconnected to solve the social problem. This book launched by the Prime Minister of India acts as a vision document for Mission Antyodaya and was given to NITI Aayog, Indian Government's think-tank for study.

India Foundation

Research Assistant

September 2016 - June 2017 (10 months)

Delhi Area, India

Graduate Intern at India Foundation (foreign policy thinktank in Delhi)

- Assisted in organising roundtables with diplomats, bureaucrats and politicians;
- Tracked Sri Lanka's current affairs from the Indian foreign policy perspective and produced weekly research briefs.
- Assisted in organising Counter-Terrorism Conference'17 & India Ideas Conclave'16.
- Authored research articles on India's foreign policy.

Education

University of California, Berkeley, Haas School of Business

Master of Business Administration - MBA, Business Administration and Management, General · (May 2027)

Shanmugha Arts, Science, Technology and Research Academy

Bachelor of Technology - BTech, Mechanical Engineering · (June 2012 - April 2016)

Ashoka University

Young India Fellowship (PG Diploma in Liberal Studies), Liberal Arts and Sciences/Liberal Studies · (July 2016 - June 2017)

University of California, Berkeley

Master of Business Administration - MBA · (August 2025 - May 2027)